

Euchre

Card Deck · 4 players in two partnerships · about 30 minutes

House rules written for The Game Room. These are the common rules; plenty of tables play their own variations, so agree on any before you start.

How to play

Use 24 cards: the 9, 10, J, Q, K and A of each suit. Partners sit opposite each other. Deal 5 cards each, turn the next card face up and set the rest aside.

Choosing trump: starting left of the dealer, each player may tell the dealer to pick up the face-up card, making its suit trump, or pass. If someone orders it up, the dealer takes it and discards a card. If everyone passes, the card is turned down and, starting left of the dealer again, each player may name a different suit as trump or pass. If everyone passes twice, redeal. The team that chose trump are the makers. The player who chose trump may go alone, and their partner sits out the hand.

Card order in trump: the jack of trump (right bower) is highest, then the other jack of the same colour (left bower, which counts as a trump), then A, K, Q, 10, 9. Other suits run A, K, Q, J, 10, 9, except that the suit of the same colour as trump has lost its jack to the left bower.

Play: the player left of the dealer leads. Follow suit if you can; otherwise play anything. The highest trump wins the trick, or the highest card of the suit led if no trump was played. The winner leads next.

Scoring: makers who take 3 or 4 tricks score 1; all 5 tricks score 2; a lone hand taking all 5 scores 4. Makers who take fewer than 3 are euchred and the other team scores 2. First team to 10 wins.